

November 18, 2024

James R. Harrington
4821 Saguaro Lane, Phoenix, AZ 85016

NOTICE OF ADVERSE BENEFIT DETERMINATION

Claim Number: BCB-CLM-2024-110-94872
Member ID: BCB-AZ-774901-J | **Group:** GRP-44120 | **Service Dates:** Oct 28-30, 2024

Dear James R. Harrington,

We have completed our review of the claim submitted by Valley General Hospital. After careful review, we are **partially denying** the service listed below. This letter explains the reason and your rights to appeal.

Denied Service

Service	CPT Code	Date	Billed Amt	Reason Code	Decision
Echocardiogram - Complete	93306	10/30/2024	\$1,650.00	CR-52	DENIED

Reason for Denial

Reason Code CR-52: Not Medically Necessary - Duplicate Service Within Review Period

Our medical review team determined that the echocardiogram (CPT 93306) on October 30, 2024 does not meet medical necessity criteria under your PPO Gold 80/20 plan (Section 4.2.1). Specifically:

- A complete echocardiogram was performed at Desert Cardiology Associates on **September 4, 2024** (Claim BCB-CLM-2024-88-71203), within the 12-month lookback window.
- Clinical notes submitted do not demonstrate a **significant change in clinical condition** to support repeat echocardiography per BCBSAZ Clinical Coverage Guideline CG-CARD-07.

Your Right to Appeal - IMPORTANT DEADLINES

Appeal Level	Who Reviews	Deadline	Decision Time
Level 1 Internal	BCBSAZ Medical Team	60 days from this letter (by Jan 17, 2025)	30 days
Level 2 Internal	Independent Panel	After Level 1 decision	30 days
External Review	Independent IRO	4 months from final denial	45 days
State Complaint	AZ Dept of Insurance	Any time	Varies

How to File a Level 1 Appeal

Submit your appeal in writing to:

BlueCross BlueShield of Arizona - Appeals Department

PO Box 13466, Phoenix, AZ 85002 | Fax: (602) 864-4945 | azblue.com/appeals

Include: this denial letter, a written statement of disagreement, supporting clinical documentation (physician letter, prior echo results, notes showing change in condition since September 2024 echo), and authorization form if a representative files on your behalf.

Expedited Appeal: If your condition is urgent, call 1-800-232-2345. Expedited decisions are made within 72 hours.

Questions? Call Member Services at **1-800-232-2345**, Mon-Fri 7am-7pm MST. You may also contact the **Arizona Department of Insurance** at 1-800-325-2548 at any time.

Sincerely,

Dr. Patricia Nguyen, MD

Chief Medical Officer, Utilization Management
BlueCross BlueShield of Arizona